

Critical Thinking (BES-103)



Lecture 1

Introduction to Critical Thinking

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Course Objectives

- ▷ To enable students to apply the general principles of logic that make patterns of argument valid or invalid;
- ▷ To develop an in-depth understanding of the concept and process of critical thinking;
- ▷ To strengthen students' ability to take ownership of content by actively thinking it through, value questions over answers, and seek understanding over memorization.

Resources

- ▷ Main
- ▷ Bassham, G, Irwin., Nardone, H, Wallace, J. Critical thinking: A Student's Introduction. New York: McGraw-Hill, 2011
- ▷ Ruggiero, R, V. Beyond Feelings: A Guide to Critical Thinking. New York: McGraw-Hill, 2012

Course Policy

▷ Attendance

- Students are expected to attend all classes
- Attendance is compulsory and will be taken regularly.
- Attendance for less than 80% of the lectures will result in students being barred from taking the Final Exam.

Course Policy

▷ Homework (Assignments)

- Homework are due at the beginning of class,
- Late homework will not be accepted,
- All works have to be done independently,
- Students handing in similar homework will receive a grade of 0 (ZERO) and face possible disciplinary actions.

Class Rules

- Cell phones are restricted during class.
- Cell phones must be turned off during the lecture.
- If your cell phone rings during class, you may be asked to leave.
- No discussion with each other during lecture
- Maintain discipline.

Course Assessment

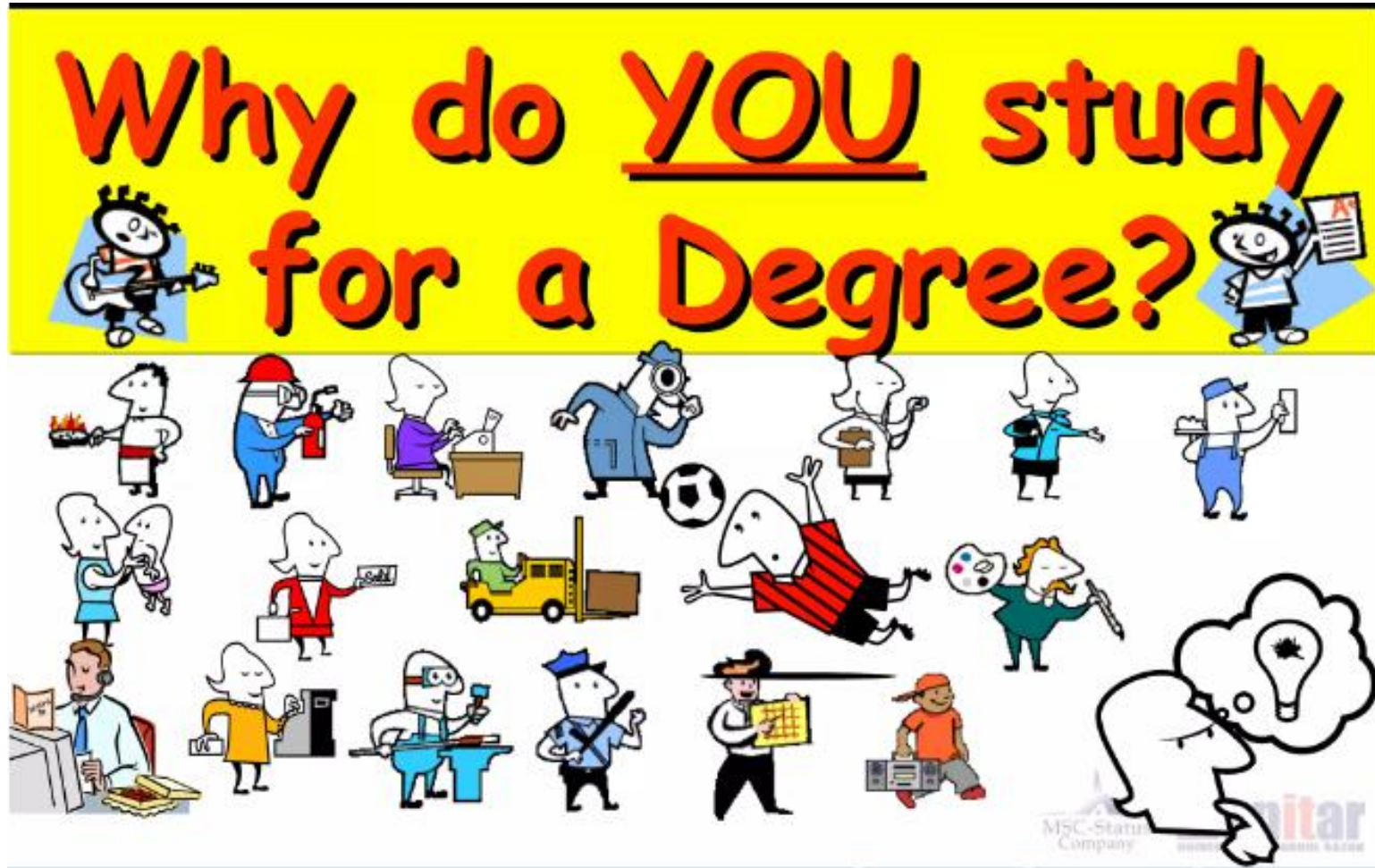
Assessment Criteria

○ Mid – Term	20%
○ Final Exam	50%
○ Quizzes	10%
○ Class Assignments/Term Project	20%

Lecture Outline

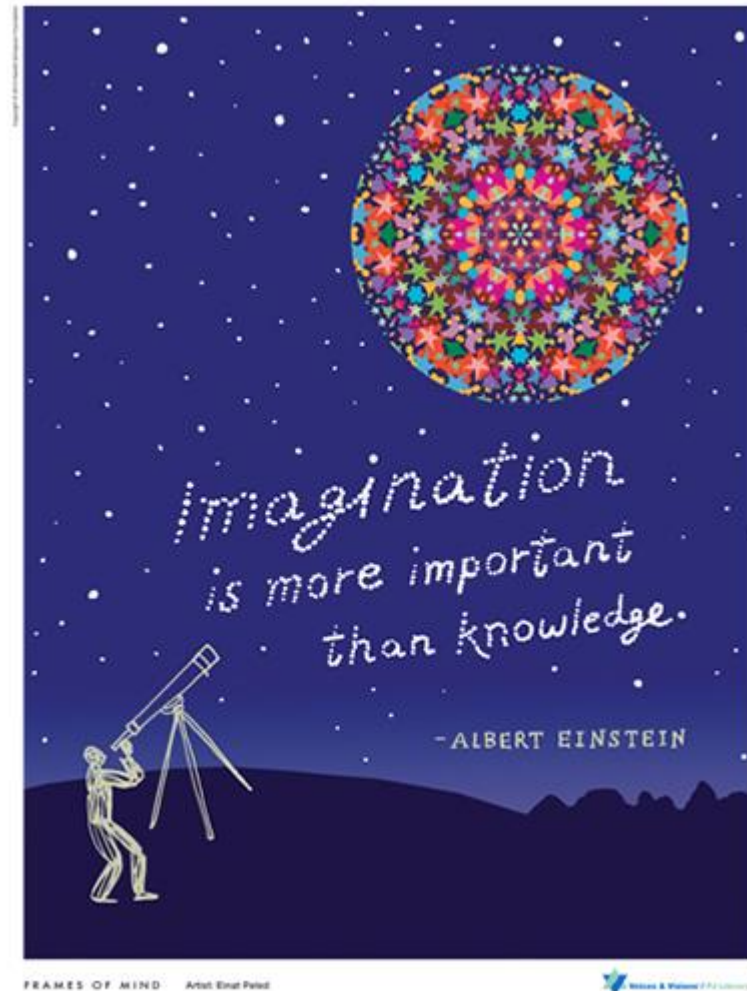
- ▷ What is critical thinking?
- ▷ Critical thinking standards.
- ▷ Benefits
- ▷ Barriers
- ▷ Characteristics

Question



Do you agree?

Why is
Imagination so
important?
I need input from
you!



What is thinking?

The action of using one's mind to produce thoughts

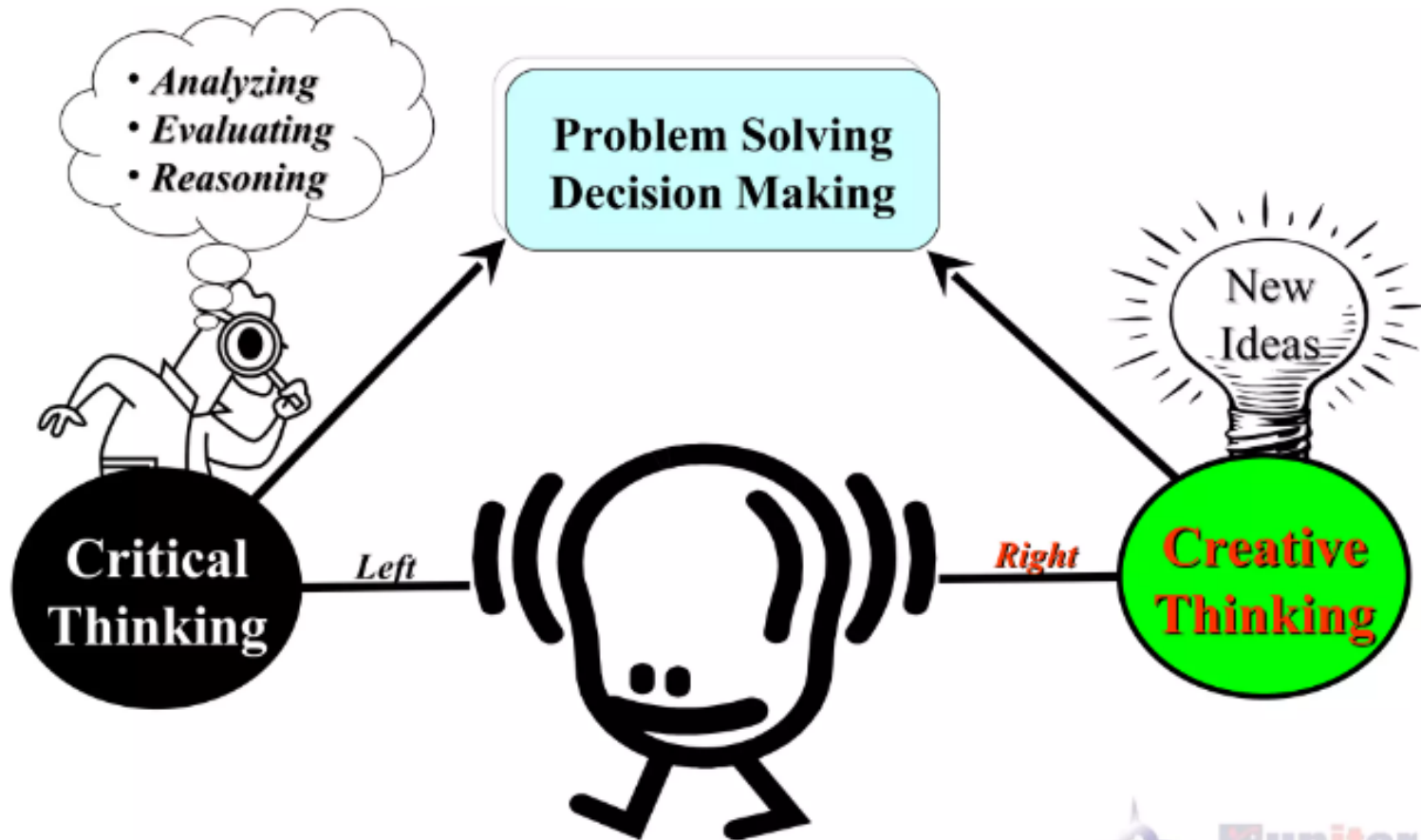
Why doesn't SHE like me?

Why doesn't HE like me?



As you start asking questions and seek answers, you are in fact thinking.

Types of thinking



What is critical thinking?

WARNING: THIS MAN IS NOT THINKING CRITICALLY!!



Source: <http://profinulder.home.att.net/introwhatis.htm>

What is critical thinking?

“Critical thinking is the intellectually disciplined process of actively and skillfully conceptualizing, applying, analyzing, synthesizing, and/or evaluating information gathered from, or generated by, observation, experience, reflection, reasoning, or communication, as a guide to belief and action”

Michael Scriven and Richard Paul (2003)

What is critical thinking?

Critical Thinking is the general term given to a wide range of cognitive and intellectual skills needed to:

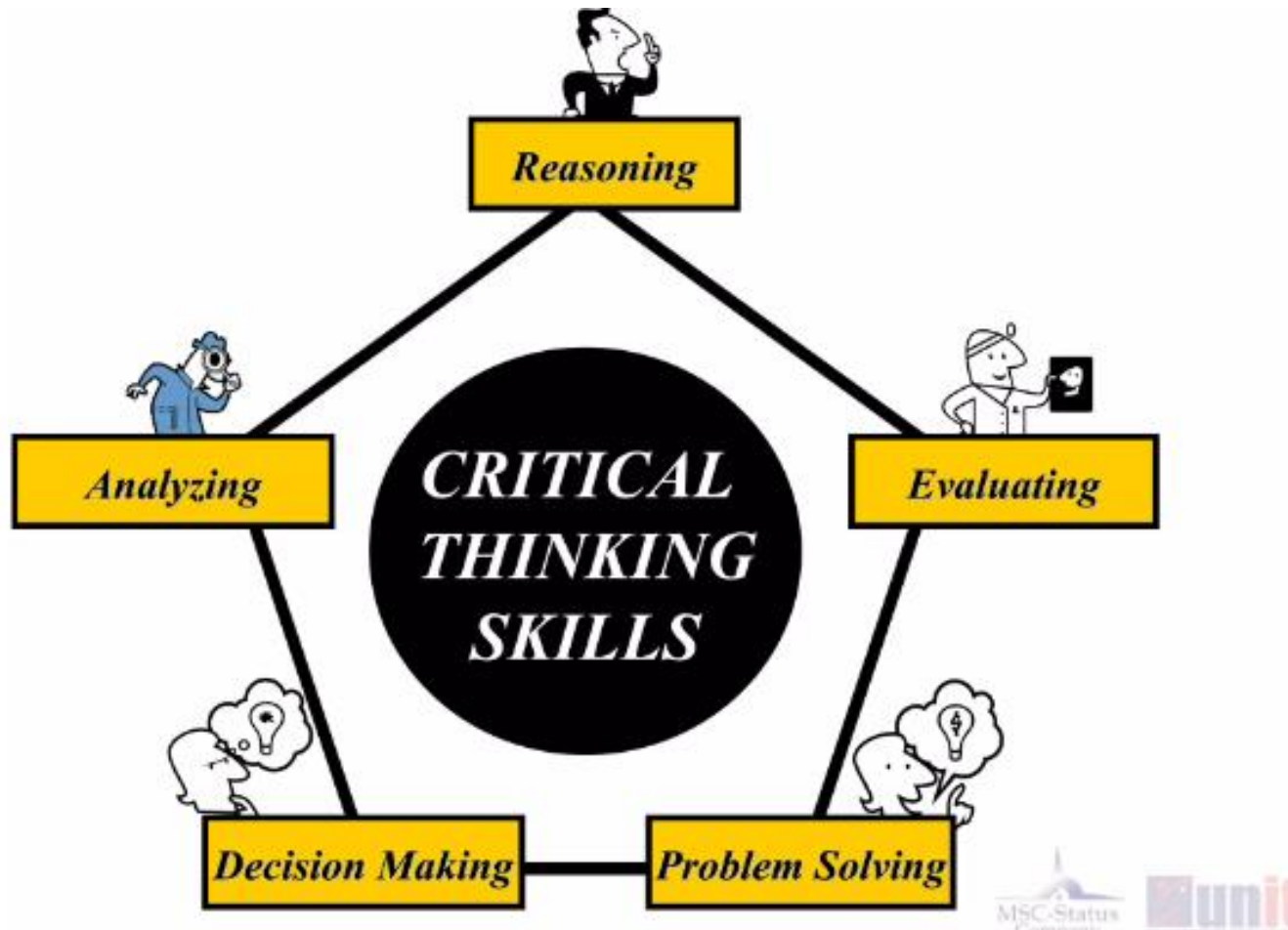
- ▷ Effectively identify, analyze, and evaluate arguments.
- ▷ Discover and overcome personal prejudices and biases.
- ▷ Formulate and present convincing reasons in support of conclusions.
- ▷ Make reasonable, intelligent decisions about what to believe and what to do.

Why Develop Critical Thinking Skills?

Critical thinking skills are important for several reasons.

- ▷ These include helping you work independently and solve problems.
- ▷ Analyze different viewpoints
- ▷ Come up with the best solution for complex problems
- ▷ Become a better learner

Critical Thinking Skills



Developing Critical Thinking Skills

Analyzing

- ▷ Understanding the significance and meaning of information
- ▷ Breaking information down into parts
- ▷ Connecting and combining information to better understand the relationship between the information



Developing Critical Thinking Skills

Reasoning

- ▷ Reasoning is the act or process of drawing conclusions from facts, evidence etc.



Developing Critical Thinking Skills

Evaluating

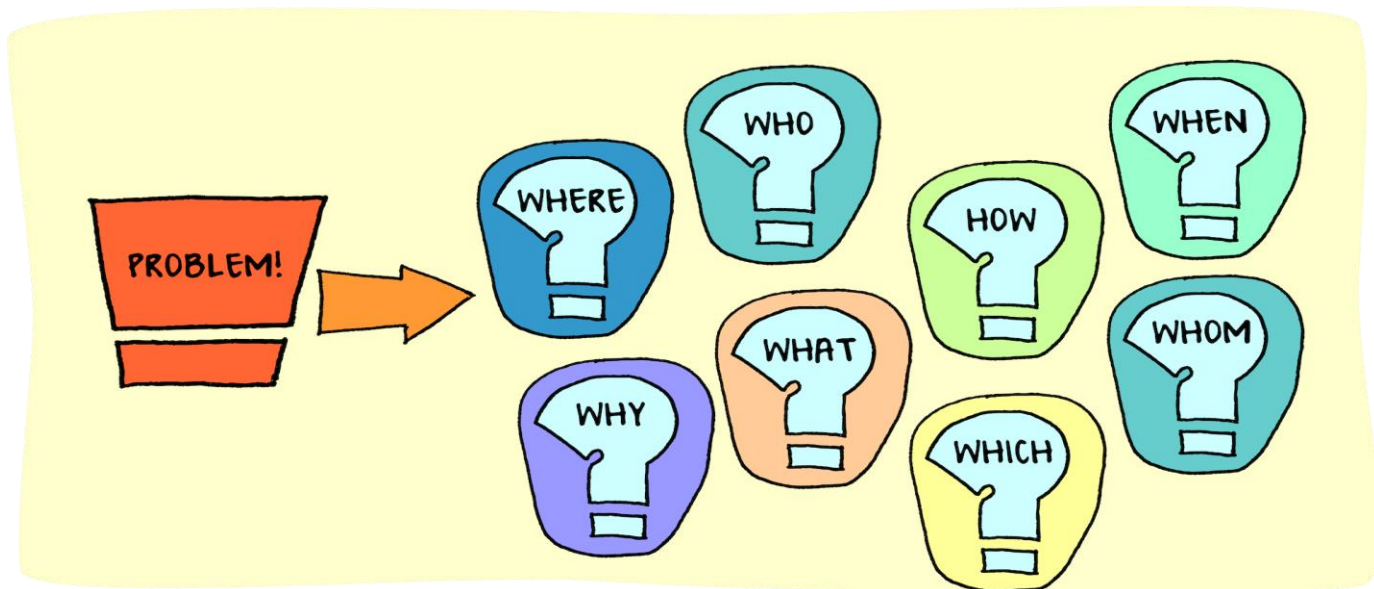
▷ Judging the value, credibility, or strength of something



Developing Critical Thinking Skills

Problem-Solving

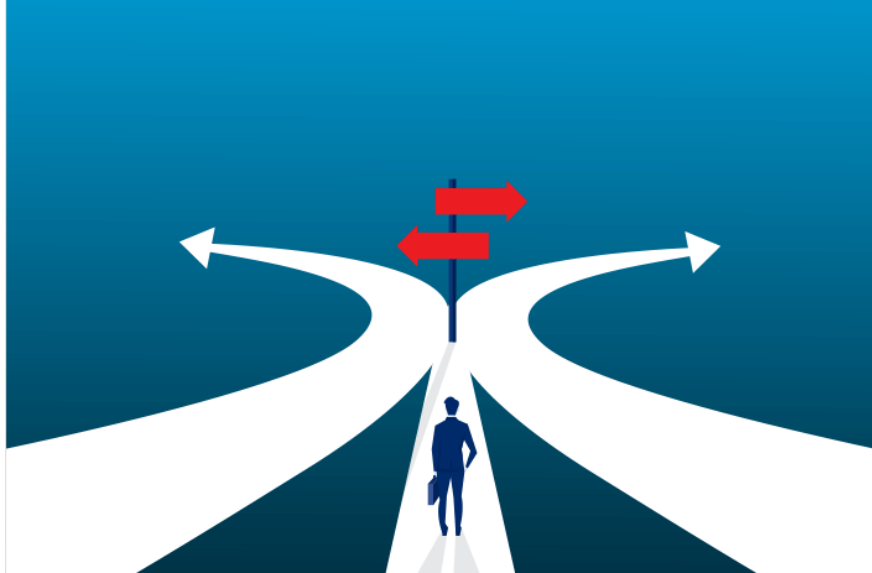
- ▷ The act of defining a problem; determining the cause of the problem; identifying, prioritizing, and selecting alternatives for a solution; and implementing a solution.



Developing Critical Thinking Skills

Decision Making

The cognitive process results in the selection of a belief or a course of action among several possible alternative options.



Exercise

Give 5 uses of a pen other than writing.



Merits of Critical thinking and demerits of non-critical thinking

Critical Thinker

- ▷ Have a passionate drive for clarity precision, accuracy, and other critical thinking standards
- ▷ Are skilled at understanding, analyzing, and evaluating arguments and viewpoints.
- ▷ Reason logically and draw appropriate conclusions from evidence and data.
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Non-Critical Thinker

- ▷ Have a passionate drive for clarity precision, accuracy, and other critical thinking standards
- ▷ Often misunderstand or evaluate unfairly arguments and viewpoints
- ▷ Reason logically and draw appropriate conclusions from evidence and data.
- ▷ Pretend they know more than they do and ignore their limitations.

Merits of Critical thinking and demerits of non-critical thinking

Critical Thinker

- ▷ Listen open-mindedly to opposing points of view and welcome criticisms of beliefs and assumptions
- ▷ Are closed-minded and resist criticisms of beliefs and assumptions
- ▷ Are closed-minded and resist criticisms of beliefs and assumptions
- ▷ Pursue truth and are curious about a wide range of issues

Non-Critical Thinker

- ▷ Are closed-minded and resist criticisms of beliefs and assumptions
- ▷ Are closed-minded and resist criticisms of beliefs and assumptions
- ▷ Tend to engage in “groupthink,” uncritically following the beliefs and values of the crowd.
- ▷ Are often relatively indifferent to truth and lack curiosity.

Reference

- ▷ <https://missionself.com/developing-critical-thinking-skills>
- ▷ https://www.slideshare.net/mqamarhayat/introduction-to-critical-thinking-8850972?from_action=save